

Max Faller's Dante Fountain (1965)

Dante Digital Monument Project · LMU München · v2.0

Working draft: This website is a preliminary version of an ongoing scholarly project. Comments and corrections: e.oezsoy@lmu.de



Identity and Context

The Dante Fountain is a bronze work by sculptor Max Faller. It was installed in May 1965, the year of Dante's 700th birthday, in the garden courtyard of the LMU building at Veterinärstraße 1. The relief program draws on the Divina Commedia and arranges Inferno, Purgatorio and Paradiso as a vertical visual journey.

Artist

Max Faller (1927-2012)

Date

1965

Material

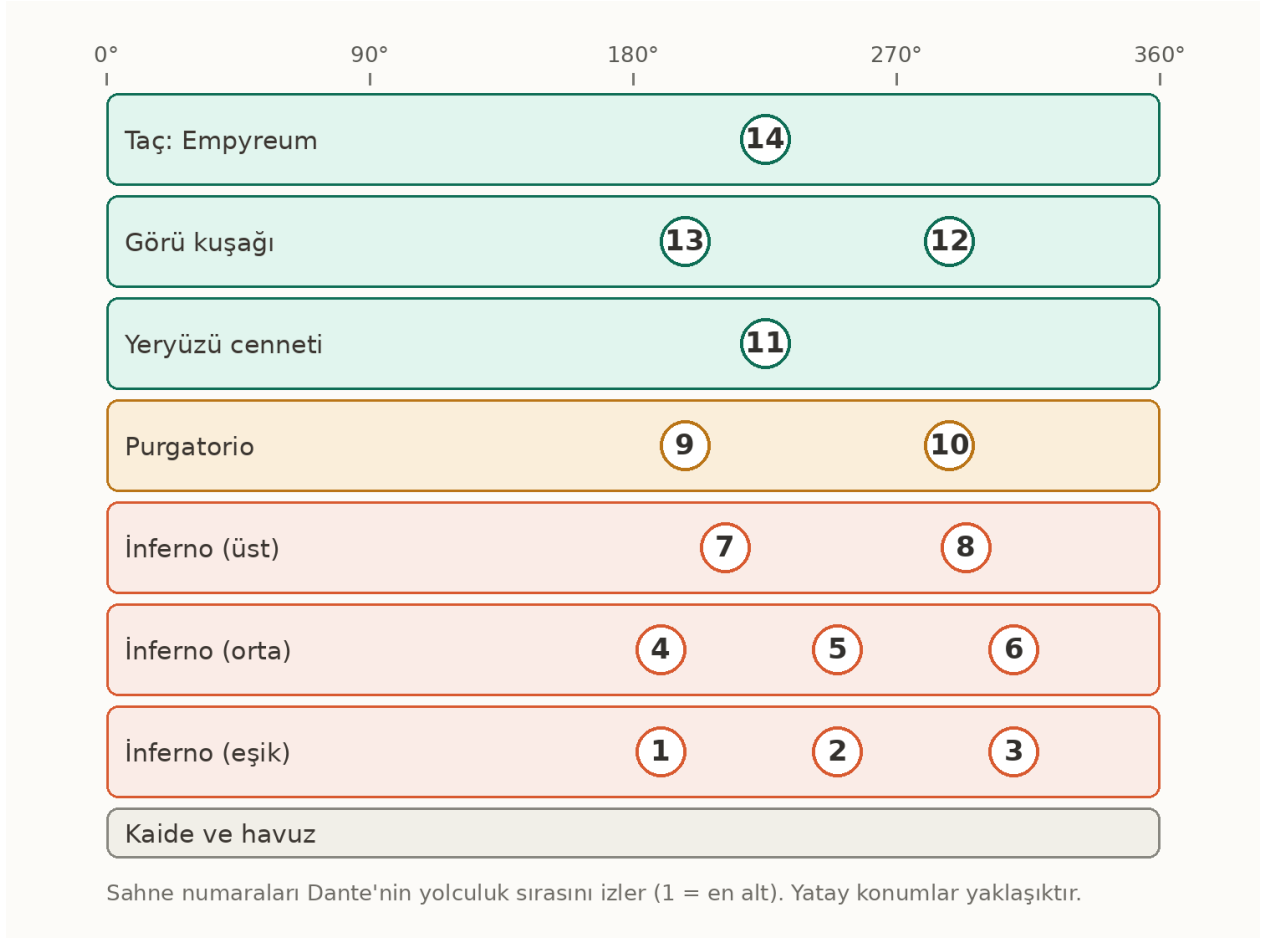
Bronze fountain

Location

LMU München, Veterinärstraße 1

Method

The cylindrical surface is conceptually unfolded into a 360-degree view. Scene identifications remain scholarly working hypotheses. The earlier excursus on Coriolanus and Dede Korkut has been removed from this project version so that the documentation remains focused on the fountain and its Dante iconography.



Scene Catalogue



1. Figure at the Threshold

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



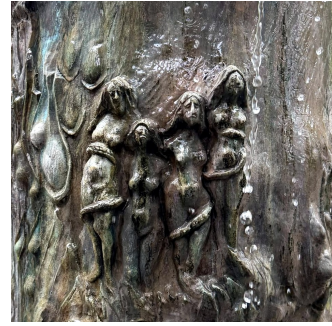
2. Women in the Waves

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



3. Seated Figure

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



5. Women Entwined with Serpents

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



4. Field of Drops and Flames

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



6. Crowd of Faces

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



7. Bodies in the Storm

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



9. Boatman and Sail-Canopy

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



8. Chain of Hands

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



10. Praying Figures in a Flame Niche

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



11. Walking Nude Couple

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



13. Figure in an Eye / Mandorla

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



12. Ascending Pair

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.



14. Robed Procession and Crown

A concise interpretation within the vertical journey from Inferno through Purgatorio to Paradiso.

Auerbach Perspective

Auerbach / Figura / Mimesis: figural reality, stylistic mixture and the tension between crowd and individual provide a useful frame for Faller's sculptural reading of Dante.

Comparative Dante Iconography

The following selection presents a few public-domain or freely licensed comparison images. It is not intended as a full inventory, but as a visual guide to the position of Faller's fountain.

Domenico di Michelino: Dante and the Three Realms (1465)

An early Renaissance image linking Dante, the city, the book and the landscape of the afterlife.

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Sandro Botticelli: Map of Hell

Botticelli translates Dante's Hell into a precise topographical order.

Wikimedia Commons · Public Domain · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/Special:FilePath/Sandro_Botticelli_-_La_Carte_de_l%27Enfer.jpg

Gustave Doré: Paolo and Francesca

Doré's Inferno illustrations strongly shaped the modern visual imagination of Dante's Hell.

Wikimedia Commons · Public Domain · https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/Special:FilePath/Gustave_Dor%C3%A9_-_Paolo_and_Francesca_da_Rimini.jpg

Auguste Rodin: The Gates of Hell

Rodin's bronze portal is the major modern point of comparison for sculptural Dante reception.

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- Wikimedia Commons file pages for the selected comparative images; license/public-domain status is documented on each file page.